MAXED **OUT**

The iPhone 18 Pro Max is less about reinvention and more about making an already formidable machine considerably harder to fault.

Verdict

The iPhone 18 Pro Max is refinement done properly. Fresh new colours and the combination of better thermals, endurance, camera control, display technology and iOS 27 makes it a formidable flagship.

Sulabh Puri



Other phones scream for attention, but the iPhone 18 Pro Max assumes you already know why it matters. At Rs 2,04,990 for 512GB in India, this is firmly luxury-tech territory. Plus, Apple has packed enough meaningful upgrades inside its familiar silhouette to make the Pro Max interesting all over again.

Familiar, but sharper

At 249g and 8.8mm, the iPhone 18 Pro Max remains a substantial piece of hardware. The aluminium build, Ceramic Shield protection and new Burgundy finish give it the expected premium feel. The cleverer change is beneath the display. Face ID's infrared camera now sits under the screen, using specially engineered pixels to let infrared light through.

Bright enough to show off

The 6.9-inch Super Retina XDR OLED remains one of the phone's stars. With 120Hz ProMotion, Dolby Vision, an anti-reflective coating and up to 3,000 nits peak brightness, it is superb for everything from spreadsheets to HDR movies.

Cooler is the new faster

As for the A20 Pro chip, it moves to 2nm and gets a redesigned thermal system with a larger vapour chamber. The result is not merely impressive benchmark potential. It is better sustained performance when gaming, editing video or pushing the phone hard. Battery life gets a sizeable boost too, with Apple quoting up to 43 hours of video playback.

Give the photographer control

The 48MP Main camera now gets variable aperture, while new Pro Controls bring shutter speed, white balance, histogram and manual aperture controls into the native camera app. The 48MP telephoto, ProRes RAW, Apple Log 2 and expanded 4K video capabilities make this considerably more interesting for serious creators.

